

Anower Hossen Zihad

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Experience

Montclair State University

Montclair, NJ

Research Assistant, School of Computing

Aug. 2025 – Present

- Design and implement experiments in **beyond-backpropagation learning** and **distributed DNN/GNN training**, using PyTorch on university HPC GPU servers.
- Analyze experiments and write research manuscripts on efficient distributed AI; Authored 2 conference papers on split learning and beyond-backpropagation training.

TS4U LLC

Remote (Warren, MI)

DevOps Engineer

2023 – 2024

- Reduced **AWS provisioning time by 30%** with Terraform and Ansible; built reusable modules with remote state for separate development, staging, and production environments.
- Built **GitLab CI/CD and Jenkins** pipelines covering automated tests, Docker image builds, ECR publishing, and Kubernetes deployments with approval gates and rollback workflows.
- Operated **production Kubernetes workloads on AWS EKS** using Helm, ingress, health checks, resource limits, and autoscaling; diagnosed failed pods and deployment issues.
- Configured IAM permissions, security groups, load balancers, DNS/TLS, secrets management, and backups for AWS environments supporting production microservices.
- Created **Grafana dashboards and Prometheus alerts**, centralized logs with EFK, and investigated production incidents using monitoring and log data.

Education

Montclair State University

Montclair, NJ

Master of Computer Science | GPA: 4.00/4.00

Expected Dec. 2026

Chittagong Independent University

Chittagong, Bangladesh

Bachelor of Computer Science and Engineering | GPA: 3.90/4.00

Aug. 2022

Projects

Urban Bangla | Python, Flask, MongoDB

<http://github.com/zihadbappy/urbanbangla>

- Built, tested, and deployed a Bengali community dictionary with Google authentication, word submissions, search, voting, and pagination.

WebRTC Video Chat | JavaScript, WebRTC

<https://github.com/zihadbappy/WebRTC-VidChat>

- Built, tested, and deployed a browser-based application supporting room-based peer-to-peer video communication through the WebRTC API.

Technical Skills

Languages: Python, Bash, SQL, JavaScript, Java

Cloud: AWS (EC2, VPC, IAM, S3, RDS, ECR, EKS, CloudFormation), DNS/TLS

Infrastructure: Terraform, Ansible, Docker, Kubernetes, Helm, secrets management

CI/CD & Observability: GitLab CI/CD, Jenkins, GitOps, Prometheus, Grafana, EFK

Development: REST APIs, unit/integration testing, code reviews, Flask, MongoDB, PyTorch

Selected Research & Presentation

Decoupled Split Learning via Auxiliary Loss | First author

Presented at the ICCN Workshop, IEEE INFOCOM 2026, Tokyo, Japan.